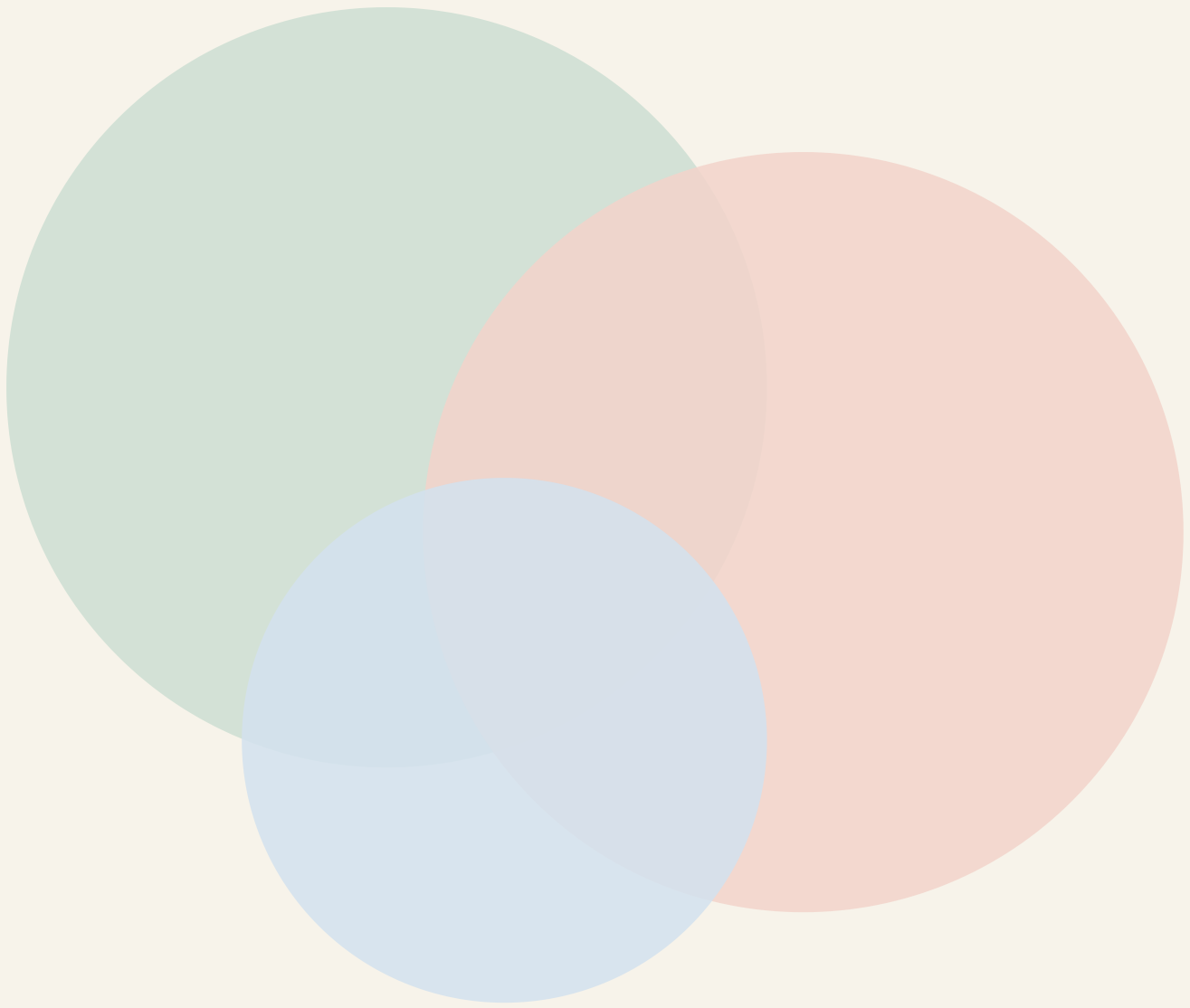




A GUIDE TO CONNECTION

Relationships & Communication

Communicate clearly. Set boundaries. Understand deeply.

Build stronger connections through better communication,
boundaries, and understanding.

8 chapters

7-day practice plan

Reflection journal

Your path in 8 chapters.

Go at your own pace. One chapter at a time.

1

Know Yourself First

Understand your needs.

2

Listen to Understand

Hear more than words.

3

Say It Clearly

Kind words. Clear message.

4

Tone and Body Language

Notice what isn't said.

5

Set Healthy Boundaries

Say yes and no honestly.

6

Handle Conflict Well

Disagree. Stay close.

7

Build Trust and Empathy

Show you care.

8

Keep Connections Strong

Nurture what matters.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Read a chapter, then try the practice at the bottom. Small, kind steps beat big, rushed changes.

Know Yourself First

Understand your needs.

01

Check in with yourself

- What am I feeling right now?
- What do I need: space, support or time?
- What triggers me, and why?

Your communication style

- Passive: avoids conflict.
- Aggressive: pushes to win.
- Passive-aggressive: hints instead of asking.
- Assertive: clear and kind. Aim here.

Your values

- List 3 things you want from relationships.
- Notice where your habits match them.

TRY THIS

Write down 3 needs you often leave unspoken.

Listen to Understand

Hear more than words.

02

Active listening

- Put your phone away.
- Make eye contact and nod.
- Let them finish before you reply.

Reflect back

- Say: "What I hear is..."
- Ask: "Did I get that right?"
- Name the feeling you notice.

Listening traps

- Planning your reply while they talk.
- Fixing when they want comfort.
- Interrupting.

TRY THIS

In one conversation today, reflect back what you heard before you respond.

Say It Clearly

Kind words. Clear message.

03

Use I-statements

- Formula: I feel ___ when ___ because ___.
- Skip “you always” and “you never”.
- Share your feeling, not a verdict.

Pick the right moment

- Ask: “Is now a good time to talk?”
- Avoid heated moments.
- One topic at a time.

Be specific

- Describe what happened, not who they are.
- State what you need.
- Keep it short.

TRY THIS

Rewrite one “you always...” sentence as an I-statement.

Tone and Body Language

Notice what isn't said.

04

Your signals

- Open, relaxed posture.
- Calm, steady voice.
- Natural eye contact.

Their signals

- Changes in tone.
- Silence or very short answers.
- Closed body language.
- Check, don't assume: "You seem quiet. All okay?"

Text vs talk

- Tone gets lost in text.
- Move heavy topics to a call or in person.
- Reread before you send.

TRY THIS

Before sending a difficult message today, read it aloud once.

Set Healthy Boundaries

Say yes and no honestly.

05

What boundaries are

- Limits that protect your time, energy and feelings.
- They are not walls or punishments.
- Healthy boundaries respect both people.

Common types

- Time: how you spend your hours.
- Emotional: what you can hold for others.
- Digital: messages, calls and sharing.
- Personal space: privacy and alone time.

How to say it

- Be calm and direct.
- "I can't do that, but I can..."
- You don't need a long excuse.
- Repeat kindly if needed.

TRY THIS

Name one boundary you need. Write one sentence to express it.

Handle Conflict Well

Disagree. Stay close.

06

Before you talk

- Pause. Breathe. Cool down.
- Decide what outcome you want.
- Assume good intent when you can.

During the conversation

- Focus on the issue, not the person.
- Take turns speaking.
- Own your part.
- Take a break if it heats up.

Repair

- Apologise for what you did and its impact.
- Ask what they need.
- Agree on one next step.

TRY THIS

In your next disagreement, pause for 10 seconds before replying.

Build Trust and Empathy

Show you care.

07

Small daily habits

- Keep your promises.
- Show appreciation out loud.
- Be on time and reliable.

Practise empathy

- Imagine their point of view.
- Say: "That sounds hard."
- Ask before giving advice.

Stay curious

- Ask open questions.
- Remember the details they share.
- Celebrate their wins.

TRY THIS

Send one genuine appreciation message today.

Keep Connections Strong

Nurture what matters.

08

Make time

- Schedule regular check-ins.
- Put important dates in your calendar.
- Quality matters more than quantity.

Reflect and grow

- Weekly: what went well? What can I improve?
- Ask for feedback kindly.
- Notice your progress.

Know when to get support

- Talk to a trusted friend, counsellor or therapist if things feel too big.
- If you ever feel unsafe, reach out for help right away.

TRY THIS

Plan one check-in conversation with someone important this week.

YOUR PRACTICE

7 days. 4 habits.

Tick each box as you go.

DAYS 1 AND 2

Notice

- ☐ Track your feelings
- ☐ Practise active listening

DAYS 3 AND 4

Speak

- ☐ Use two I-statements
- ☐ Express one boundary

DAYS 5 AND 6

Connect

- ☐ Send an appreciation message
- ☐ Have one check-in chat

DAY 7

Reflect

- ☐ Review what went well
- ☐ Pick one habit to keep

REMEMBER

Progress, not perfection. Every honest conversation builds the habit.

Pause. Reflect.

Write freely. No one else needs to read it.

One thing I do well in communication

A pattern I want to change

A need I want to express

A boundary I want to set

Someone I want to thank

A conversation I'm avoiding

How I will listen better

One small step this week

SMALL STEPS, STRONGER CONNECTIONS

Be patient with yourself and with others.

This guide offers general self-help ideas, not professional advice.